

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday April 13, 2023

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #79, April 13, 2023

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:03 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (8/11): Francesco Cesarini, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Bryan Paxton, Kenneth Lundin, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, and Alistair Woodman.

The following members of the board of directors were absent: Sophie DeBenedetto, Ben Marx, Miriam Pena Villanueva.

Agenda Items

1. Approval of minutes from previous meetings.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #78 held on March 16, 2023. Unanimously approved

2. Intermediate actions and activities:

1. Due diligence regarding stipend applicant Benjamin Philip completed (with the help of José Valim).
2. Directors & Officers insurance offer made and accepted by Alistair, we are waiting for the contract to bind.
3. Alistair and Sebastian intend to complete tax filings by May 15.
4. Sebastian has applied for membership for EEF on techsoup.org.

3. Treasury and membership update: Sebastian presented a quick summary of the current financial status, see table below. Peer presented the membership numbers (changes since last report, meeting 77 on March 2 in parenthesis): Annual Supporting: 141 (-4), Basic 1199 (+33), Lifetime 18 (unchanged), Managing and Contributing: 18. Total 1384 (+33).

Cash in Bank	\$	185,833
Pledged Sponsorship (not yet received)	\$	44,000
Pledged Stipends (not yet paid out)	\$	(49,450)
	\$	180,383

4. Unanimous consent votes: none scheduled
5. Board election status. As communicated widely (including a blog post on the EEF website) we chose to invalidate the election results, and redo the election. The new voting period is Friday Apr 14th at 07:45 AM PDT to Saturday Apr 22nd at 07:45 AM PDT. Thanks to everyone involved for the hard work and difficult decisions. And thank you, Fred for writing an incident report describing what happened. After the election is over we should have a post-mortem to discuss how we can improve for next year.
6. Stipend requests:
 1. Leo Rubiano for \$4,200 to cover the cost of a learn-elixir.dev course. Request did not come through a working group, nor did it seem to benefit the community at large. No one proposed to put it to a vote. Not approved.
 2. Louis Pilfold for \$6,000 to develop an Exercism syllabus for Gleam. Francesco to sherpa. Longer discussion around the proposal. (Noted that better Exercism syllabus for Erlang is needed). Approval of the application proposed by Francesco and seconded by Fred.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the stipend request by Louis Pilfold for \$6,000 to develop an Exercism syllabus for Gleam. Approved by vote: 6 for the motion (Alistair, Bryan, Francesco, Fred, Peer, Sebastian) and 2 against (Kenneth, Maxim).

7. Any other business:
 1. Sebastian (and Peer, and others) brought up the stipend process. We want to improve it: the feedback and responsiveness to applicants, prompter payout, better follow-up on the projects. Perhaps more input from the community on proposals. Sebastian, Peer, Alistair, and Bryan volunteered to work on improvement suggestions.

2. Fred requested that we have board meeting attendance reporting - Sebastian will follow up.

8. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:03 UTC.

Dated April 13, 2023

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Stipend request from Louis Pilfold (2 pages)

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Training Program

First name : Louis

Last Name : Pilfold

Nick Name : lpil

Country : United Kingdom

Twitter : louispilfold

Website : <https://gleam.run/>

Bio :

Hello! I'm Louis, a BEAMer through and through! ✨ I first came to the BEAM through Elixir around the time of v1.0, with a focus on tooling and open source projects. I wrote the first Elixir linter which later evolved into Credo, the main Elixir linter to this day, and the first Elixir code formatter, which influenced and motivated the official Elixir code formatter. For the past 5 years my focus has been on Gleam, a new language that brings statically typed programming and (more importantly) fans of typed programming to the BEAM to grow the ecosystem. Gleam is funded entirely through donations and is my full time job. I am also a long-time user and contributor to Exercism, the educational programming language website around which this proposal is centred. I was a notable early contributor to the Elixir track, and I implemented and launched the first versions of the Gleam track and the PureScript track.

Purpose

Exercism is an education programming website where people can go to learn or practise any of 67 programming languages free of charge, with 1,300,000 students currently enrolled. Further details on the scale and impact of Exercism can be found on their website: <https://exercism.org/about/impact> Most of the students have not used a BEAM language before and as such prominent BEAM tracks serve as a new way for people to discover the BEAM ecosystem. The MVP of the Gleam track was launched on January 26th to great success, with 229 students, 3,825 exercise submissions, and 48 one-on-one mentoring sessions so far. The majority of the students I personally mentored had not used a BEAM language before and either discovered the BEAM through Exercism, or knew of the BEAM but hadn't used a BEAM language before learning about Gleam. The track consists of "practice exercises": programming challenges taken from Exercism's language agnostic challenges library and adapted to Gleam. The purpose of this stipend is to fund one month of development time to design and implement a "concepts" syllabus: a custom progression of lessons and challenges designed specifically for the language. With this syllabus, the Exercism track would be a fast-track for someone to go from having an interest in the language to being a comfortable BEAM programmer with Gleam. The Elixir track features an excellent concepts syllabus which will serve as the gold-standard of quality which the Gleam syllabus will match. The Elixir syllabus can be viewed and participated in here: <https://exercism.org/tracks/elixir/concepts>

Report : The report is to contain a mix of quantitative and qualitative data about the course and the Gleam portion of the BEAM community. - Students over time. - Exercise submissions over time. - Open source contributions over time. - Gleam Discord server membership over time. - Testimonials from students. - Testimonials from mentors. - Track content additions over time. Along with an analysis and lessons learnt over the development and running of the track. As the track has no end-date I would like to produce a report 1 year after launch rather than one month after to have more data, though 1 month can be the length if that is the preference of the EEF.

Stipend Amount (USD) : 6000

Beneficiaries : The stipend is to fund one month of my time for the development and implementation of the Gleam syllabus. Once created it will be available on the Exercism website in perpetuity for students to use free of charge, and in Exercism's public GitHub source code repository for further community maintenance and development. One and one mentoring of students will be performed on an ongoing basis by myself and other BEAM/Gleam community members.